

SARA KIM

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Personal Statement

15 years in Data/AI/ML, most of it spent on systems other teams depend on. Comfortable leading technical decisions, pushing back on scope when it matters, and carrying a pager for what I build. Primary tools: PyTorch and Airflow.

Academic Background

High School

West Andrea High School | 2010

Experience

Applied Scientist, Harbor Point Tech

August 2014 to Current

- Built an end-to-end training pipeline on PyTorch, cutting retraining from days to 5 hours.
- Developed an NLP classification system in Python reaching 82% F1, replacing a manual review queue.
- Cut inference cost by 15% through quantisation, batching and autoscaling on Docker.
- Wrote the team's model documentation and review standard, now required before any production launch.
- Established offline/online evaluation parity, catching 4 silent regressions before release.

Machine Learning Engineer

Nova Tech Group | January 2012 to May 2014

- Built the feature store that 2 downstream models now read from, ending duplicated feature logic.
- Translated ambiguous business questions into a modelling roadmap with product and finance stakeholders.
- Productionised demand forecasting models that reduced stock-outs by 15% across 8 regions.
- Migrated ad-hoc notebooks into versioned Databricks pipelines with reproducible runs and tracked experiments.

Vantage Analytics — Junior Applied Scientist

June 2010 to October 2011

- Mentored 50 analysts moving into modelling work, with weekly paper reading and code review.
- Ran A/B tests across 12 model variants; the winning variant added an estimated \$120k in annual revenue.
- Reduced label noise by redesigning the annotation guidelines, improving validation accuracy by 12%.

Projects

Commute optimiser

Pulls transit APIs and suggests departure times, built on Python.

Home energy dashboard

Collects meter readings and renders them with CI/CD. Mostly an excuse to learn time-series storage properly.

Professional Certifications

Certified ScrumMaster (CSM) — Scrum Alliance, 2021

AWS Certified Developer - Associate — Amazon Web Services, 2023

Google Analytics Certification — Google, 2019

Selected Publications

"Scheduling strategies for distributed task queues" - technical report, 2012. Cited internally as the basis for the current design.